

3.1 Characteristics of the Antarctic ecosystem

1 Match the following characteristics, a-d to their definitions, 1–4.

- | | |
|------------------|---|
| a flora | 1 elements of an ecosystem that are living organisms |
| b fauna | 2 plants |
| c biotic | 3 elements of an ecosystem that are non-living or without life |
| d abiotic | 4 animals |

2 How have animals adapted to survive in Antarctica?

« RECALL AND CONNECT 1 »»

Glaciers and ice sheets across the world are melting and causing sea-level rise. This is because of climate change. See if you can answer these questions linked to [Topic 5, 'Climate change'](#).

- a** What is thermal expansion in relation to climate change?
- b** What are ice cores and how have they advanced knowledge about climate change?

UNDERSTAND THESE TERMS

- Ecosystem
- Biotic

- Abiotic
- Thermal expansion

For 'sketch' questions, ensure that your drawing includes key details relevant to the question, even if the drawing is not the most artistic illustration. Start with a light outline and then add labels (short words or phrases that name or identify features of the sketch) and annotations (brief sections of text that describe or explain features and processes in more detail) to explain important features.

- ~~3~~ Sketch a diagram to explain why Antarctica experiences 24 hours of sunlight at certain times of the year. [5]
- ~~4~~ Sketch a diagram to show why the air above Antarctica is usually cold and dry. [5]

REFLECTION

Sketching can help break down complex information. This means that sketching can make it easier to remember key information. Does sketching make your revision notes easier to understand and remember? Can you include more sketches in your study notes?